

Emergency Triage Protocol

Emergency Department

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Department: Emergency Department

Status: Active

1. Purpose

Establishes a standardized method for prioritizing Emergency Department patients according to clinical urgency, using a 5-level Emergency Severity Index (ESI) framework.

2. Triage Levels

- Level 1 — Resuscitation (Red): Immediate life threat, seen immediately
- Level 2 — Emergent (Orange): High risk, seen within 10 minutes
- Level 3 — Urgent (Yellow): Stable but needs multiple resources, seen within 30 minutes
- Level 4 — Less Urgent (Green): Single resource needed, seen within 60 minutes
- Level 5 — Non-Urgent (Blue): Minor complaint, seen within 120 minutes

3. Triage Nurse Responsibilities

- Perform rapid primary assessment (airway, breathing, circulation, disability)
- Record vital signs, presenting complaint, and allergy status
- Assign an ESI level and route the patient to the appropriate care area
- Re-triage patients whose condition changes while waiting

4. Re-Assessment Intervals

Level 2 patients are reassessed every 15 minutes, Level 3 every 30 minutes, and Level 4-5 every 60 minutes while awaiting physician assessment.

5. Escalation

Any patient who deteriorates while waiting must be immediately escalated to Level 1 or 2 and moved to the resuscitation or acute area regardless of position in the queue.